AMS Security Employment Handbook

Version History

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Table of Contents

1. INTRODUCTION 5
1.1 Welcome 5
1.2 Purpose of the Employee Handbook 5
1.3 Commitment to Equality and Fair Treatment 5
1.4 General Provisions 5
2. JOINING AMS SECURITY 5
2.1 Induction 5
2.2 Probationary Period 6
2.3 Employee Training 6
2.4 Job Description 7
2.5 Performance and Review 7
2.6 Availability 7
2.7 Job Flexibility 7
2.8 Mobility 7
2.9 Convictions and Offences 7
3. REMUNERATION AND HOURS 8
3.1 Administration 8
3.2 Superannuation 8
3.3 Time Recording 8
3.4 Hours of Work 8
3.5 Lateness and Absenteeism 9
3.6 Breaks 9
3.7 Shortage of Work 9
3.8 Stand Down 9
4. OTHER LEAVE 10
4.1 Annual Leave 10
4.2 Personal/Carers Leave and Compassionate Leave 10
4.3 Parental leave 10
4.4 Community Service Leave 10
4.5 Family and Domestic Violence Leave 10
4.6 Public holidays 10
4.7 Long Service Leave 10
4.8 Time Off 10
5. SAFEGUARDS 10
5.1 Rights of Search 10
5.2 Information Technology and Computer Use 10
5.3 Social Media 12
5.4 Phones and Devices 12
5.5 Surveillance 12
6. STANDARDS 12
6.1 Behaviour at Work 12
6.2 Customer Service 13
6.3 Client Premises 13
6.4 Damage to Client Property 13

6.5 Tools and Equipment 13
6.6 Gifts and Gratuities 13
6.7 Media 13
6.8 Friends and Family in the Workplace 13
6.9 Conflict of Interest 14
6.10 Wastage 14
6.11 Dress and Appearance 14
7. CLIENT INTERACTIONS AND BOUNDARIES 15
7.1 Introduction 15
7.2 Client Interaction 15
7.3 Responsibilities 15
7.4 Procedure 15
8. GENERAL TERMS 16
8.1 Changes in Personal Details 16
8.2 Secondary Employment 16
8.3 Banking and Expenses 16
8.4 Employee Property and Lost Property 16
9. WHISTLEBLOWER POLICY 17
9.1 Introduction 17
9.2 Scope and Eligible Disclosers 17
9.3 Responsibility to Report 17
9.4 Reportable Conduct 17
9.5 Reporting Channels 17
9.6 Investigation 18
9.7 Confidentiality 18
9.8 Protections 18
10. CAPABILITY 18
10.1 Job Changes / General Capability Issues 18
10.2 Personal Circumstances / Health Issues 19
11. DISCIPLINARY POLICY 19
11.1 Introduction 19
11.2 Disciplinary Rules 19
11.3 Examples of Unsatisfactory Conduct / Misconduct 20
11.4 Serious Misconduct 20
11.5 Disciplinary Procedure 20
12. BULLYING AND HARASSMENT POLICY 21
12.1 Introduction 21
12.2 Harassment 21
12.3 Bullying 21
12.4 Reasonable Management Action 21
12.5 Complaint Procedure 22
13. SEXUAL HARASSMENT 22
13.1 Introduction 22
13.2 Definition 22
13.3 Complaint Procedures 23

13.4 General Notes 23
14. GRIEVANCE 23
15. PRIVACY 24
15.1 Purpose 24
15.2 Collection of Personal Information 24
15.3 Responsibilities 24
16. EQUAL OPPORTUNITIES AND ANTI-DISCRIMINATION 24
16.1 Statement of Policy 24
16.2 Recruitment and Selection 24
16.3 Diversity in the Workplace 25
17. GENDER EQUALITY AND ANTI-DISCRIMINATION 25
17.1 Statement of Policy 25
18. MOTOR VEHICLES 25
18.1 General Requirements 25
18.2 Fixtures, Fittings, and Modifications 25
18.3 Cleaning and Maintenance 25
18.4 Fuel Cards 26
18.5 Fines 26
18.6 Loss or Theft 26
18.7 Permitted Use 26
18.8 Personal Liability 26
18.9 GPS Tracking/Dashcams 26
19. WORKPLACE IN GENERAL 26
19.1 Introduction 26
19.2 General Requirements 26
19.3 Housekeeping 27
19.4 Hygiene 27
19.5 Fitness for Work 27
20. DRUGS AND ALCOHOL 27
20.1 Illicit Drugs and Alcohol 27
20.2 Prescribed/Over-the-Counter Medication 27
20.3 Screening 27
20.4 No Smoking Policy 28
21. TERMINATION OF EMPLOYMENT 28
21.1 Resignations 28
21.2 Failure to Provide Required Notice 28
21.3 Employment References 28
21.4 Return of Employer Property 28
21.5 Return of Vehicles 28
21.6 Garden Leave 28
22. EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK ACKNOWLEDGEMENT 29

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Welcome

AMS Security (the *Employer*) extends a warm welcome to you. Whether you are a new team member or an existing employee, we wish you every success in your role. We are committed to ensuring that your employment experience with us is safe, positive, and rewarding.

1.2 Purpose of the Employee Handbook

This Employee Handbook outlines the Employer's rules, policies, and procedures, together with information about your rights, responsibilities, and entitlements during your employment. It also explains the standards of conduct expected of all employees.

All employees are required to familiarise themselves with, and comply with, this Handbook. Breaches may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

If you are unclear about any aspect of this Handbook, you should seek clarification from your manager.

1.3 Commitment to Equality and Fair Treatment

AMS Security is committed to providing equal employment opportunities and upholding the principles of fairness, equity, and respect, in line with applicable workplace legislation.

Unlawful discrimination, harassment, or victimisation of colleagues, clients, contractors, suppliers, or members of the public will not be tolerated and may result in disciplinary action. We expect all employees to uphold these principles in the course of their duties.

1.4 General Provisions

The Employee Handbook may be amended from time to time to reflect legislative changes, operational requirements, or policy updates. Employees will be notified of such amendments.

This Handbook does not form part of your contract of employment unless expressly stated in writing. However, it may be considered when interpreting your rights and obligations under your employment contract.

1.5 Access to Industrial Instruments

Where relevant, employees have access to the *Security Services Industry Award 2020* and the *National Employment Standards (NES)*. Copies are available electronically upon request.

2. JOINING AMS SECURITY

2.1 Induction

At the commencement of your employment, you will be required to participate in an induction program. This will include information about AMS Security's policies, procedures, and workplace health and safety requirements. Access to relevant documents and resources will be provided during induction and throughout your employment.

2.2 Certification and Clearance Requirements

All employees and contractors of AMS Security must hold and maintain, for the duration of their employment or engagement, any licences, certifications, and clearances required to lawfully and competently perform their duties.

This may include, but is not limited to:

- A current and valid South Australian Security Licence
- A current Driver's Licence, where driving forms part of the role
- A current First Aid and CPR certificate issued by a nationally recognised Australian Registered Training Organisation (RTO)
- A current Responsible Service of Alcohol (RSA) certification, where required by the role or client
- A current Working With Children Check (WWCC), where required by the role or client
- A current National Police Clearance Certificate

Evidence Requirements
AMS Security reserves the right to request evidence of any required licence, certification, or clearance at any stage of employment, including where operational requirements, client needs, or legislative obligations change. This requirement supports other obligations outlined in:

- Section 2.1 – Induction, where employees must be made aware of compliance requirements
- Section 3 – Remuneration and Hours, where employment conditions depend on lawful capacity to work
- Section 11 – Disciplinary Policy, where failing to meet employment obligations may constitute misconduct

Failure to Maintain Requirements
Failure to maintain required licences, certifications, or clearances may result in redeployment, suspension, or disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. Consequences for non-compliance are consistent with:

- Section 10 – Capability, where an employee is unable to perform required duties
- Section 11.3 – Examples of Unsatisfactory Conduct / Misconduct
- Section 11.4 – Serious Misconduct, where working without required legal authorisations may constitute a serious breach

2.3 Probationary Period

The length of your probationary period is set out in your employment contract. Casual employees are not subject to probation.

During probation, your performance, conduct, and suitability for the role will be assessed. Where concerns arise, the Employer may:

- provide additional support or training.
- extend the probationary period; or
- terminate your employment.

The Employer reserves the right to apply simplified disciplinary procedures during the probationary period.

2.4 Employee Training

You will be provided with training necessary for your role at the commencement of your employment. As business needs evolve, you may be required to undertake additional training, including but not limited to:

- refresher training on AMS Security policies and procedures.

- client site inductions; and
- compliance or industry-mandated training.

All employees are expected to participate fully in training to maintain the required standards of performance.

2.5 Job Description

A job description may be provided to outline your key responsibilities. The Employer reserves the right to update your job description to reflect changing business needs, provided the changes are reasonable and consistent with your role.

2.6 Performance and Review

AMS Security monitors performance on an ongoing basis to ensure that employees are meeting expectations and to support development where needed. Formal performance reviews may be conducted as required.

2.7 Availability

Employees must provide their availability to the Employer in writing.

- Casual employees: Changes to availability may impact the number of hours offered.
- Permanent employees: Changes to contracted availability may only occur by mutual agreement with the Employer.

All changes to availability must be submitted in writing to management.

2.8 Job Flexibility

You may be required to perform alternative or additional duties from time to time, including covering colleagues during periods of leave or working across different sites. Such flexibility is necessary to ensure the effective operation of the business.

2.9 Mobility

It is a condition of employment that you may be directed to perform duties at any AMS Security or client site within a reasonable travel distance. Reasonable consideration will be given to your personal circumstances when making such arrangements.

2.10 Convictions and Offences

Employees are required to immediately notify the Employer if they are:

- charged with a criminal offence; or
- convicted of a criminal offence.

Failure to disclose this information may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

3. REMUNERATION AND HOURS

3.1 Administration

i) Payment

- Wages are processed fortnightly in arrears:
    - Standard employees: processed on Tuesday, normally available in your bank account by Wednesday (subject to your bank's processing times).
    - Retail guard employees: processed on Thursday, normally available by Friday.
- You will receive an itemised payslip showing gross pay, deductions (such as tax and superannuation), and net pay.
- Any pay queries should be directed promptly to management.
- Pay details are strictly confidential and must not be discussed with other employees.

ii) Overpayments
If you are overpaid, the Employer is entitled to recover the overpayment. Recovery will normally be made by deduction from your next wage payment. If this would cause financial hardship, repayment arrangements may be agreed.

iii) Overtime

- All overtime must be authorised by your AMS Supervisor or management before being worked.
- Unapproved overtime will not be paid.
- Additional hours worked to complete ordinary duties (e.g., correcting errors in your own work) are considered *reasonable additional hours* under the Fair Work Act and will not normally attract overtime payments.

iv) Pay Reviews
Wages are reviewed annually in July. A review does not guarantee a pay increase unless required by legislation, Award obligations, or written contract.

3.2 Superannuation

Superannuation contributions will be made on your behalf in accordance with the *Superannuation Guarantee (Administration) Act 1992* and applicable legislation.

3.3 Time Recording

- Employees must clock on and off duty, and for breaks, using the Guardhouse App.
- Failure to record time correctly may delay wage processing until the following pay period.
- Falsification of records — including clocking in/out for another employee or allowing another employee to clock in/out for you — is considered serious misconduct and may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

3.4 Hours of Work

- Employees may be rostered to work Monday through Sunday.

- The Employer operates 24 hours per day, seven days per week. Hours of operation and roster requirements may change to meet client or operational needs.

3.5 Lateness and Absenteeism

- If you are going to be late to work or returning late from a break, you must notify your supervisor/manager as soon as possible, advising of your expected arrival time.
- Pay may be deducted for lateness. If you are more than one hour late without notice, your shift may be reassigned, and you may be sent home without pay.
- If you become unfit for work or need to leave early, you must seek approval from your manager before leaving the workplace. Supporting evidence (e.g., medical certificate or statutory declaration) may be required.
- Absences due to illness must comply with the *personal leave notification and evidence requirements* in this Handbook.
- Unauthorised lateness or absence may result in disciplinary action.

3.6 Breaks

- Breaks must be taken at the times directed by the Employer.
- You must adhere to the allocated break length and return to duty promptly.
- If you are unable to take your scheduled break, you must notify management immediately so alternative arrangements can be made.

3.7 Shortage of Work

- If a temporary shortage of work occurs, the Employer will endeavour to maintain continuity of employment.
- With employee agreement, this may involve reduced hours (with pay adjusted accordingly) or leave without pay.
- Employees may elect to use accrued annual leave instead of unpaid leave.

3.8 Stand Down

The Employer may lawfully stand you down without pay where there is no useful work available, including (but not limited to):

- breakdown of equipment,
- industrial action, or
- circumstances beyond the Employer's control (e.g., natural disaster, government direction).
- Where possible, employees may access accrued leave entitlements by agreement during stand down.

4. LEAVE

4.1 Annual Leave

4.2 Personal/Carers Leave and Compassionate Leave

4.3 Parental leave

4.4 Community Service Leave

4.5 Family and Domestic Violence Leave

4.6 Public holidays

Further information can be found for all the above entitlements in the Security Services Award 2020

4.7 Long Service Leave

Long service leave entitlements are provided in accordance with the legislation of the state or territory in which you are employed.

4.8 Time Off

- Appointments (medical, dental, etc.) should be scheduled outside working hours wherever possible.
- Where this is not possible, time off may be approved at management's discretion and will usually be unpaid unless other leave entitlements are used.

5. SAFEGUARDS

5.1 Rights of Search

The Employer reserves the right to conduct searches of you and/or your property (including vehicles) while you are on company premises or performing work duties.

- Where practicable, searches will be conducted in the presence of a colleague of your choice (if available at the time).
- You may be required to remove the contents of your pockets, bags, vehicles, or other personal property for inspection.
- You have the right to refuse a search. However, refusal may be considered a failure to follow a lawful and reasonable management direction and may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.
- The Employer reserves the right to notify or involve police authorities at any stage.

5.2 Information Technology and Computer Use

(i) Virus Protection

To protect company systems from malicious software:

- Only authorised software may be installed or used.
- All software must be virus-checked using approved procedures prior to use.

- Downloading or installing programs without authorisation is strictly prohibited.

(ii) Use of Computer Equipment

- Only authorised employees may access company computer systems.
- Software and applications must be approved by management before use.
- Unauthorised copying, removal, or use of software or equipment may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.
- No software or data may be removed from or introduced to company systems without prior authorisation.

(iii) Internet Use

The internet may be used for legitimate business purposes only. Employees must not:

- Access, download, or distribute offensive, pornographic, or otherwise inappropriate material.
- Use company systems for personal, illegal, or non-work-related purposes.
- Breach copyright, licensing, or intellectual property rights.
- Engage in hacking, unauthorised access, or activities that compromise security.
- Use company networks to access the internet on personal devices without authorisation.

Unauthorised or inappropriate internet use may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination, and may also constitute a criminal offence.

(iv) Email Use

Work email is provided for legitimate business purposes. Employees must:

- Use professional and respectful language at all times.
- Ensure confidentiality is maintained where applicable.
- Avoid sending messages that could be regarded as abusive, discriminatory, or harassing.
- Not use email for personal correspondence, social media, gambling, chain letters, or transmission of offensive or inappropriate material.

Any misuse of the email system may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

(v) Monitoring

All company systems, including email and internet use, are company property and may be monitored, reviewed, and recorded without prior notice. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Internet browsing history.
- Time spent online.
- Content uploaded, downloaded, or shared.
- Emails sent and received.

Monitoring is conducted to protect the Employer's business interests, ensure compliance with policies, and maintain system security. By using company systems, you consent to such monitoring. Information obtained may be used in disciplinary proceedings.

5.3 Social Media

- Employees must not post work-related matters on social media without prior written authorisation.
- Where authorised, employees must ensure that posts are professional, respectful, and do not bring the Employer, its clients, or associated parties into disrepute.
- Personal use of social media during work time is prohibited.
- Any breach of this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

5.4 Phones and Devices

- Company phones, laptops, body cameras, and devices are to be used strictly for work purposes.
- Personal mobile phones should not be used during work hours unless for work-related reasons.
- Mobile phones must remain accessible so management can contact you when required.
- Mobile phones must never be used where this poses a safety risk or interferes with duties.
- Unauthorised use of company devices may result in repayment obligations and disciplinary action.

5.5 Surveillance

Workplace surveillance may include:

- Internet and email usage monitoring.
- CCTV or other visual recording devices.
- Audio or electronic recording systems.

Surveillance may occur at any time, continuously or intermittently, at the Employer's discretion, and records may be used for security, safety, or disciplinary purposes.

Surveillance will not occur in bathrooms, change rooms, or any location prohibited by law.

Unauthorised secret recordings of workplace conversations or activities may constitute serious misconduct.

6. STANDARDS

6.1 Behaviour at Work

Employees must act with professionalism, civility, and respect toward colleagues, clients, and the public.

- Offensive, insulting, or abusive behaviour will not be tolerated.
- Employees must devote full attention to work duties during paid hours.

- Engaging in activities that compete with the Employer is prohibited.

6.2 Customer Service

Employees are expected to maintain high standards of customer service, including:

- Promptly attending to duties and customer needs.
- Greeting customers courteously.
- Communicating clearly, respectfully, and professionally.
- Respecting confidentiality and customer property.

Failure to meet customer service standards may result in disciplinary action.

6.3 Client Premises

While working at client sites:

- Access is restricted to authorised areas only.
- Personal searches, removal of items, or unauthorised photography are strictly prohibited.
- Any breach will be considered serious misconduct and may result in termination.

6.4 Damage to Client Property

Employees are responsible for taking reasonable care when using or handling client property.

- Wilful or negligent damage may result in financial liability for repairs or replacement.
- Costs may be recovered from wages, subject to lawful deduction provisions.
- Disciplinary action may also apply.

6.5 Tools and Equipment

Employees are responsible for all tools and equipment issued.

- Reasonable care must be taken to prevent loss or damage.
- Negligent loss or misuse may result in financial liability or replacement costs.
- Equipment must be returned upon request or at the end of employment.

6.6 Gifts and Gratuities

Employees must not accept gifts, benefits, discounts, entertainment, or hospitality from clients, suppliers, vendors, or other parties, regardless of value, unless expressly approved in writing by management.

This includes items such as promotional merchandise, meals, tickets, or personal discounts.

6.7 Media

Employees must not comment to or engage with the media regarding the Employer or its clients. All media enquiries must be referred to the Managing Director.

6.8 Friends and Family in the Workplace

Friends and family are not permitted in the workplace except:

- In emergencies; or
- For approved, legitimate business purposes.

Approval must be obtained in advance where practicable.

6.9 Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid any actual or potential conflicts of interest. Where a conflict arises, it must be disclosed immediately.

The Employer may take steps it considers appropriate to resolve the conflict, which may include reassignment, shift changes, or termination.

6.10 Wastage

Employees are expected to support a “minimum waste” approach by:

- Conserving electricity and resources.
- Handling equipment and stock with care.
- Avoiding unnecessary or inefficient use of company time and resources.

Negligence, vandalism, or failure to follow procedures that result in loss or damage may lead to recovery of costs and disciplinary action.

6.11 Dress and Appearance

Employees must maintain a professional appearance, good hygiene, and wear the designated uniform and personal protective equipment (PPE) at all required times.

Uniform standards include:

- Clean, ironed uniform worn in full.
- Covered tattoos while on duty.
- Black steel-capped boots with dark socks.
- Neat, trimmed hair and facial hair.
- No excessive jewellery: only small studs, wedding bands, or simple rings permitted.
- White undershirts only (no prints or colours).
- Uniform badges covered when travelling to and from work.

Uniforms and PPE must be returned at the end of employment. Costs may be deducted from final pay where items are not returned.

Failure to comply with dress and appearance requirements may result in being sent home without pay and/or disciplinary action.

7. CLIENT INTERACTIONS AND BOUNDARIES

7.1 Introduction

This policy outlines the standards of professionalism that AMS Security (the Employer) requires of all employees when interacting with clients, tenants, contractors, and members of the public. It also defines clear boundaries to prevent conflicts of interest and to protect the reputation of both the Employer and the employee.

7.2 Client Interaction

Employees must conduct themselves in a professional, respectful, and impartial manner always while on duty, on client premises, or otherwise representing the Employer.
Employees must not engage in inappropriate or non-professional relationships with clients, client employees, tenants, their staff, or customers. Prohibited conduct includes (but is not limited to):

- Connecting on personal social media platforms (e.g., "friending" or following).
- Exchanging personal contact details (phone numbers, emails, social media accounts).
- Communicating with such persons outside of work duties and hours, unless expressly authorised.
- Attending social events or gatherings at the invitation of any such person, except where expressly approved by the Employer.
- Becoming involved in the personal, private, or non-work-related matters of any such person, unless encountered as part of legitimate work duties and reported through the appropriate channels.

7.3 Responsibilities

- **Employer Responsibilities**: The Employer will ensure that all employees are made aware of this policy and understand the potential consequences of a breach.
- **Employee Responsibilities**:
    - Adhere strictly to this policy when on duty or representing the Employer.
    - Avoid and report any inappropriate personal relationship or conflict of interest involving clients, tenants, or associated persons.
    - Immediately notify the Operations Manager if a personal relationship exists or develops that could reasonably be perceived as compromising professional boundaries.
    - Politely and professionally decline invitations to attend social gatherings organised by clients, tenants, or their representatives unless expressly directed to attend by the Employer.
    - If unexpectedly present at a gathering where a client or related person is in attendance, maintain professional conduct, and notify the Operations Manager at the earliest opportunity.

7.4 Procedure

While on duty, or in AMS Security uniform, employees must:

- Maintain professional standards of communication and conduct.
- Avoid fraternisation or behaviour that could be perceived as forming a personal relationship.
- Not attend client functions with a partner unless expressly authorised in writing by the Managing Director.
- Avoid wearing the uniform in venues such as hotels or bars, and refrain from any conduct that could damage AMS Security's reputation.
- Politely decline any invitation to attend social events organised by clients or tenants unless required to attend by the Employer in an official capacity.

8. GENERAL TERMS

8.1 Changes in Personal Details

Employees must promptly notify the Employer of any changes to personal details, including but not limited to name, address, phone number, emergency contact, banking details, or licensing information, so that accurate and compliant records can be maintained.

8.2 Secondary Employment

Employees must devote their full working hours to the Employer's business. Any additional employment, self-employment, or other business activity must be disclosed in writing and approved by the Employer in advance.
Approval will consider:

- Working hours and fatigue management obligations.
- Any conflict of interest with the Employer's operations.
- Potential reputational or competitive risks.
- Health, safety, and wellbeing considerations.

The Employer may refuse or withdraw approval where conflicts or risks arise. Undertaking secondary employment without approval may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Employees must not perform services like those performed for the Employer at their residence or elsewhere for personal compensation, unless expressly authorised.

8.3 Banking and Expenses

- Employees will be reimbursed for reasonable business expenses, provided these are pre-approved and supported by valid receipts.
- Employer credit cards and bank accounts must only be used for authorised business purposes and handled securely. Misuse will be treated as serious misconduct.

8.4 Employee Property and Lost Property

The Employer does not accept responsibility for personal property brought onto client or company premises. Employees are discouraged from bringing items of high value to work and must always take reasonable care of their belongings.

9. WHISTLEBLOWER POLICY

9.1 Introduction

AMS Security is committed to the highest standards of integrity, ethics, and accountability. In accordance with the **Corporations Act 2001 (Cth)**, this policy provides protections for eligible whistleblowers who disclose misconduct or an improper situation without fear of victimisation, harassment, or discriminatory treatment.

9.2 Scope and Eligible Disclosers

This policy applies to any individual who is, or has been, associated with AMS Security, including:

- Employees, officers, directors.
- Contractors, suppliers, consultants (and their employees).
- Associates of the Employer.
- Relatives, dependants, or spouses of any of the above.

Protections also apply to disclosures made to a legal practitioner for the purpose of obtaining legal advice about whistleblower rights.

9.3 Responsibility to Report

Employees and associated persons are encouraged and expected to report suspected misconduct in good faith. Maintaining a culture of transparency and integrity relies on such disclosures.

9.4 Reportable Conduct

Reportable Conduct includes, but is not limited to:

- Dishonest, fraudulent, or corrupt activity.
- Misuse of company funds or resources.
- Unlawful or unethical conduct.
- Misleading or improper accounting or reporting practices.
- Oppressive, discriminatory, or grossly negligent behaviour.
- Unsafe practices or serious risks to health, safety, or the environment.
- Serious misconduct likely to cause financial or reputational harm to the Employer.

Personal workplace grievances (e.g., interpersonal conflicts or routine employment decisions) generally do not constitute Reportable Conduct and should be managed under the grievance policy, unless they involve retaliation against a whistleblower.

9.5 Reporting Channels

Disclosures may be made to:

- A Senior Manager.
- An Eligible Recipient (Director, Officer, Senior Manager, or external auditor/actuary).

Disclosures may be made in person, by phone, or email. Disclosers should clearly state that they are making a report under this policy.

9.6 Investigation

- Reports will be assessed to determine if they fall within the scope of Reportable Conduct.
- Investigations may be conducted internally or by an independent investigator.
- All investigations will be fair, objective, and proportionate to the seriousness of the allegations.
- Disclosers may remain anonymous. Identifying information will not be shared without consent, except where legally required or reasonably necessary for the investigation.

9.7 Confidentiality

The Employer will take all reasonable steps to protect the confidentiality of a whistleblower's identity. Information may only be disclosed:

- To ASIC, APRA, or the Australian Federal Police.
- To a legal practitioner for advice.
- With the whistleblower's consent.

9.8 Protections

A whistleblower making a protected disclosure will not be subject to civil, criminal, or disciplinary liability for doing so.
The Employer strictly prohibits retaliation. Detrimental conduct includes dismissal, demotion, discrimination, harassment, intimidation, or reputational or financial harm.
Any retaliation will be treated as serious misconduct and may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, as well as potential civil or criminal liability.

10. CAPABILITY

We recognise that during your employment there may be times when you are less capable of performing your duties. This may occur if:

- The requirements of the role change over time and you are unable to keep pace, or
- Your personal circumstances or health affect your ability to perform your work.

The Employer retains discretion to apply capability procedures in a way that considers your length of service, circumstances, and any mitigating factors.

10.1 Job Changes / General Capability Issues

Where concerns arise about your ability to perform your role, the Employer will:

- Clearly explain the standards of performance required.
- Provide reasonable training, guidance, and supervision to support improvement.
- Discuss concerns with you informally in the first instance, allowing reasonable time for improvement.

If performance remains unsatisfactory:

- A written warning may be issued, outlining the required improvements and consequences of failing to meet them.
- Consideration may be given to transferring you to more suitable duties if available.

If, after a reasonable period, there is no improvement, no alternative role is available, or your performance is having a substantial detrimental impact, your employment may be terminated with appropriate notice.

10.2 Personal Circumstances / Health Issues

Where health or personal circumstances affect your ability to perform normal duties, the Employer may request medical information (with your consent) to help assess your capability. This may include a medical report from your treating doctor.

Following consultation with you and review of available information, a decision will be made regarding:

- Your continued employment in your current role, or
- Transfer to alternative duties (where practicable).

Where attendance at work is affected by prolonged absence or frequent short-term absences, medical advice may also be sought. After reasonable consultation, a decision will be made about your continued employment or redeployment to a more suitable role, where available.

11. DISCIPLINARY POLICY

11.1 Introduction

This policy sets out the standards of performance and behaviour expected by the Employer and the procedures that will be followed if disciplinary issues arise.

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Promote fairness, consistency, and transparency.
- Encourage improvement rather than impose punishment.
- Ensure employees are given the opportunity to be heard.

Employees will not normally be dismissed for a first breach of discipline unless the conduct amounts to serious misconduct. Suspension with pay may be used, where necessary, to enable a fair investigation.

Employees have the right to be accompanied by a support person at all formal disciplinary hearings.

11.2 Disciplinary Rules

Disciplinary action may arise from:

- Breach of specific conditions or procedures outlined in this Handbook.
- Failure to meet reasonable standards of performance, behaviour, or conduct.

The list below provides examples of conduct that may lead to disciplinary action but is not exhaustive.

11.3 Examples of Unsatisfactory Conduct / Misconduct

- Breach of health and safety procedures or reckless actions affecting safety.
- Persistent absenteeism or lateness.
- Unsatisfactory work standards or performance.
- Rudeness, harassment, bullying, or offensive language towards clients, colleagues, or members of the public.
- Unauthorised use of company email, internet, or social media.
- Failure to follow reasonable management instructions.
- Unauthorised or inappropriate use of company property or vehicles.
- Failure to report accidents, incidents, or driving convictions where required.

11.4 Serious Misconduct

Serious misconduct is conduct that fundamentally breaches the employment relationship and may result in termination without notice. Examples include (but are not limited to):

- Theft, fraud, or other criminal conduct.
- Violence, threats, bullying, or harassment.
- Serious breaches of health and safety obligations.
- Deliberate damage to company or client property.
- Possession or influence of illegal drugs while at work.
- Serious acts of discrimination or sexual harassment.

11.5 Disciplinary Procedure

Disciplinary outcomes may include:

- Formal verbal warning.
- Written warning.
- Final written warning.
- Termination of employment.

Offence	1st Occasion	2nd Occasion	3rd Occasion	4th Occasion
Unsatisfactory conduct	Verbal warning	Written warning	Final warning	Termination
Misconduct	Final warning	Termination		
Serious misconduct	Termination			

The Employer reserves the right to bypass stages depending on the seriousness of the matter, employee length of service, and circumstances.

12. BULLYING AND HARASSMENT POLICY

12.1 Introduction

The Employer is committed to providing a safe, respectful, and inclusive workplace. Bullying, harassment, and discrimination are unacceptable and will not be tolerated under any circumstances.

Such behaviour undermines morale, performance, and wellbeing, and may also breach workplace laws.

12.2 Harassment

Harassment is any unwanted conduct (verbal, physical, written, or online) based on a protected attribute (such as sex, race, disability, age, religion, or sexual orientation) that offends, humiliates, intimidates, or creates a hostile environment.

Sexual harassment includes any unwelcome conduct of a sexual nature, including comments, jokes, advances, requests for favours, or physical behaviour.

A single incident may constitute harassment.

Examples include (but are not limited to):

- Insults, offensive jokes, or pranks.
- Lewd comments about appearance.
- Intrusive personal questions.
- Display of offensive material.
- Unwelcome sexual advances or touching.

12.3 Bullying

Bullying is repeated; unreasonable behaviour directed towards a worker or group that creates a risk to health and safety. A single serious incident may also amount to bullying.

Examples include:

- Abusive or offensive comments.
- Persistent unjustified criticism.
- Threats, exclusion, or isolation.
- Spreading rumours or misinformation.
- Withholding information or resources needed to perform work.

12.4 Reasonable Management Action

Reasonable actions taken in a fair and respectful way do not constitute bullying or harassment. Examples include:

- Setting performance goals or deadlines.
- Providing constructive feedback.
- Managing performance or behaviour concerns.
- Making operational changes or disciplinary decisions.

12.5 Complaint Procedure

Employees who experience or witness bullying or harassment are encouraged to raise concerns early. Complaints may be:

- Informal: Speak directly with the person involved (if safe to do so) or raise the matter confidentially with a senior colleague.
- Formal: Submit a written complaint to management, including details of the conduct, dates, witnesses, and any actions taken.

Upon receiving a complaint:

- The Employer may separate parties during the investigation (including temporary suspension on pay if necessary).
- A fair and confidential investigation will be conducted.
- Both parties will be informed of the outcome.

Employees who make genuine complaints will not be victimised. However, deliberately false, or malicious complaints will be treated as misconduct.

Disciplinary action (up to and including termination) will be taken against employees found to have engaged in bullying or harassment.

13. SEXUAL HARASSMENT

13.1 Introduction

The Employer is committed to a safe, healthy, and respectful workplace where everyone is treated with dignity. Sexual harassment is a form of sex discrimination and is unlawful under the **Sex Discrimination Act** and **Fair Work Act**.

Sexual harassment will not be tolerated. It can seriously affect morale, confidence, health, and performance, for both those directly affected and witnesses.

13.2 Definition

Sexual harassment is any unwelcome sexual behaviour that could reasonably be expected to offend, humiliate, or intimidate a person. It can be physical, verbal, or written. Examples include:

- Unwelcome touching, staring, or leering.
- Suggestive comments, jokes, or taunts
- Sharing sexually explicit materials (emails, posters, pictures)
- Unwanted invitations, requests for sex, or intrusive questions about personal life or body

- Behaviour that may be criminal (e.g., sexual assault, stalking, indecent exposure)

Mutual, consensual flirtation or affection is **not** considered sexual harassment. A **single incident** may constitute harassment.

Sexual harassment may occur **inside or outside the workplace**, including work-related events or off-duty interactions between colleagues.

Managers and supervisors have a duty to:

- Model appropriate behaviour.
- Educate staff on obligations.
- Respond promptly and appropriately to any sexual harassment.

All staff, including contractors, trainees, and volunteers, must ensure their behaviour is respectful. Disciplinary action, including termination, may result from sexual harassment.

13.3 Complaint Procedures

Informal Complaint

You may raise concerns with a senior colleague (confidential helper) if a formal grievance is not appropriate. Victims may:

- Ask the harasser to stop the behaviour directly, or
- Provide a written request, with assistance from a confidential helper.

Formal Complaint

If informal resolution fails or the harassment is serious:

- Submit a written complaint to management, with support from a confidential helper.
- Include details such as names, dates, witnesses, and any prior actions taken.

The Employer may temporarily separate parties or suspend employees (with pay) during investigation. Meetings will be scheduled reasonably, and you may be accompanied by a work colleague or confidential helper. Investigations will normally conclude within **10 working days**, and outcomes will be communicated in writing.

If you choose not to proceed, the Employer may still take action to protect workplace safety and wellbeing, including training, reminders, monitoring, or process reviews.

13.4 General Notes

- Well-founded complaints will result in appropriate action against the harasser.
- Complaints made in good faith will **not** result in victimisation.
- Malicious or false complaints may result in disciplinary action.

14. GRIEVANCE

Employees who are dissatisfied with any matter relating to their employment (excluding harassment, which has a separate procedure) should:

- Attempt to raise the matter informally with their manager first, if possible
- If a formal grievance is required, submit it in writing.

  The manager will investigate and arrange a meeting at a reasonable time. You must take all reasonable steps to attend. A written response will normally be provided within **10 working days**.

15. PRIVACY

15.1 Purpose

The Employer is committed to the proper handling of personal information, even where the **Privacy Act** does not strictly apply.

15.2 Collection of Personal Information

Personal information may be collected during recruitment and throughout employment for administrative, compliance, and operational purposes. This may include:

- Employment terms, performance, and conduct
- Emergency contact and personal details
- Hours worked, pay, leave, and benefits.
- Membership of professional associations or trade unions

You must ensure all personal information provided is **accurate and current**.

15.3 Responsibilities

Employees must maintain confidentiality and **not disclose or misuse** personal information of colleagues, clients, or the Employer. Breaches may result in disciplinary action.

16. EQUAL OPPORTUNITIES AND ANTI-DISCRIMINATION

16.1 Statement of Policy

The Employer is committed to ensuring no discrimination occurs based on:

- Age, disability, gender identity, marital status, pregnancy, race, religion, sex, sexual orientation

Breaches of this policy may result in disciplinary action, including termination. Contractors will also be made aware of their responsibilities.

16.2 Recruitment and Selection

Recruitment, promotion, and advancement will be merit-based. Steps to ensure fairness include:

- Training for staff involved in recruitment.
- Non-discriminatory job advertisements
- Multiple reviewers for shortlisting and interviewing
- Job-relevant, non-discriminatory interview questions

- Decisions free from staff prejudice

16.3 Diversity in the Workplace

The Employer values a **diverse and inclusive workplace**. Employees are expected to:

- Respect all cultures, backgrounds, opinions, and beliefs.
- Promote a welcoming, safe, and non-discriminatory environment.

Disciplinary action may result from failure to comply.

17. GENDER EQUALITY AND ANTI-DISCRIMINATION

17.1 Statement of Policy

The Employer promotes **gender equality** and is committed to:

- Fair recruitment and employment practices
- Representation, recognition, and value of all genders
- Measurable improvements in gender equality outcomes

The workplace will remain neutral, safe, and free from intimidation. Contractors will also be informed of their responsibilities.

18. MOTOR VEHICLES

18.1 General Requirements

You may be required to use a motor vehicle to perform your duties. Vehicles used in the course of work are considered a workplace, and the Employer has health and safety obligations. All company vehicles are registered and insured in accordance with legislation.

When driving a branded Employer vehicle, you are representing the Employer. You must drive safely, courteously, and in accordance with road laws. Complaints about driving behaviour may lead to investigation and disciplinary action.

18.2 Fixtures, Fittings, and Modifications

No fixtures (e.g., roof racks, aerials, towing apparatus, stickers) may be added to vehicles without written approval. Modifications to the manufacturer's mechanical or structural specifications are not permitted.

18.3 Cleaning and Maintenance

- Vehicles must be kept clean, tidy, and free of rubbish or personal items. Smoking is prohibited in Employer vehicles.
- Maintenance, repairs, or replacement of parts require prior authorisation. Reimbursement will only be made if approved.
- Drivers must check and maintain oil, water, battery, brake fluid, and tyre pressure before and after use. Tyre tread must meet legal requirements.

- Costs for cleaning or valet may be deducted from pay if vehicles are returned in poor condition.

18.4 Fuel Cards

Fuel cards are for business use only. Odometer readings must be recorded at the time of fuel purchase. Cards must be kept secure, and purchases must comply with company rules regarding location, product, and spending limits.

18.5 Fines

You are responsible for fines incurred while using Employer vehicles (e.g., parking, speeding, tolls). The Employer may pay fines on your behalf and recover costs from your pay.

18.6 Loss or Theft

- Immediately report vehicle theft or theft of contents to the police and the Employer.
- Only Employer property is insured; personal items are your responsibility.
- Always secure the vehicle, set alarms if fitted, and store items out of sight. You may be held responsible for negligence.

18.7 Permitted Use

Employer vehicles are for authorised business use unless otherwise approved. Vehicles may not be used for hire, reward, or motor sports. Vehicles may need to be returned during periods of leave unless agreed otherwise.

18.8 Personal Liability

You may be required to cover costs for accidents or damage caused by negligence. This includes any vehicle attachments, modifications and badging that is required. Repeated incidents may result in disciplinary action or loss of vehicle privileges.

18.9 GPS Tracking/Dashcams

Vehicles may be fitted with GPS devices for security and monitoring driver behaviour. GPS usage will be disclosed, and devices will be clearly marked in the vehicle. Data may be collected continuously and used in accordance with privacy legislation.

Dashcams are installed and must not be touched or adjusted, this includes interference to the microphone of the dashcam.

19. WORKPLACE IN GENERAL

19.1 Introduction

This section outlines day-to-day practices to ensure health and safety in the workplace.

19.2 General Requirements

- Do not alter or remove plant, equipment, or safety devices without permission.
- Comply with all safety signs, policies, and procedures.
- Illegal drugs are prohibited; intoxicated individuals are not permitted on site.
- Wear and use personal protective equipment (PPE) at all appropriate times.

19.3 Housekeeping

Maintain a neat and safe workplace:

- Keep emergency exits, thoroughfares, and aisles clear.
- Place rubbish in bins provided.
- Ensure work and communal areas are clean and tidy.

19.4 Hygiene

- Cover any cuts or burns with appropriate dressings.
- Do not attend work with infectious or contagious diseases without medical clearance.
- Report contact with contagious individuals before starting work.

19.5 Fitness for Work

Employees not fit for work may be sent home for safety reasons, with or without pay. A medical certificate may be required before returning to work. Disciplinary action may result in cases of non-compliance.

20. DRUGS AND ALCOHOL

20.1 Illicit Drugs and Alcohol

- Zero tolerance for illicit drugs in the workplace.
- Alcohol consumption must be responsible; blood alcohol content must be 0.00% when operating vehicles, machinery, or performing high-risk work.
- Non-compliance may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

20.2 Prescribed/Over-the-Counter Medication

Notify management if taking any medication that may affect your ability to work safely. A medical certificate may be required.

20.3 Screening

The Employer may conduct:

- Pre-employment testing
- Testing based on reasonable suspicion or following incidents.
- Random testing

Disciplinary action may occur for:

- Impairment at work
- Positive test results
- Refusal to participate in testing.
- Possession of drugs in the workplace or Employer vehicles

Work may be suspended and return to work may require negative test results.

20.4 No Smoking Policy

Smoking is prohibited in Employer vehicles, on premises, and while in uniform. Smoking is only permitted in designated areas during breaks. Client site policies must also be followed.

21. TERMINATION OF EMPLOYMENT

21.1 Resignations

All resignations must be submitted in writing, including the reason for resigning from your position.

21.2 Failure to Provide Required Notice

If you terminate your employment without providing the required notice, you may not be entitled to your full termination pay. Depending on your employment contract and relevant terms, an amount equivalent to all or part of the notice not provided may be withheld from your final pay.

21.3 Employment References

Requests for employment references should be directed to management. Employees are not authorised to provide references for current or former colleagues without management consent. The Employer may provide a Statement of Service upon request.

21.4 Return of Employer Property

Upon termination, you must return all Employer property in your possession or for which you are responsible. Failure to return items within seven days may result in the cost being deducted from any monies owing to you. All items should be returned to management.

21.5 Return of Vehicles

Employer vehicles must be returned to the company premises upon termination. Failure to return the vehicle may result in the cost of recovery being deducted from any outstanding pay.

21.6 Garden Leave

If notice is given by either you or the Employer, the Employer may require you to take “garden leave” for all or part of your remaining employment period. During garden leave:

- You will remain employed and continue to receive your full salary and contractual benefits.
- You are not permitted to undertake any work duties unless expressly authorised.
- Secondary employment is not permitted without Employer approval.
- Employer property must be returned if requested.
- The Employer may require you to return to work during garden leave if necessary.

22. EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I, _____, acknowledge that I have received a copy of the AMS Security Employee Handbook and that I have read and understood its contents.

Signed: _____

Date: _____

To be returned to your AMS Manager ASAP.

Manager Receiving: _____

Date Received: _____

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. **Please Photograph the Acknowledgement**
2. **Scan the QR Code and attach the copy of this acknowledgement to submit it.**

Email Compliance